

2. **Showcase your skills.** When we hire interns, we're looking for exceptional young men and women who have set themselves apart. James had extensive experience as a management consultant, working with Fortune 500 companies in consumer goods and retail; during the recruitment process, he also met with angel investors, incubators and venture capitalists. Rebecca's portfolio included a large range of work in both conventional and unconventional media, and her previous interning experience in design, art direction, PR and social media gave her a unique edge. Ramin ran a profitable media business that sold product-placement spots to national and international brands; he was also studying concurrently for his Juris Doctor and MBA after receiving a dual degree in chemistry and chemical engineering, giving him a broad range of analytical skills. Each of our interns brought diverse talents and backgrounds to the table.
3. **Always have a backup plan.** Rebecca applied for a handful of internships her senior year and considered more than one offer. James met with seven companies in the venture capital industry; he spent two months scheduling meetings and interviews before choosing the internship with us. Ramin applied for nearly 50 summer jobs in addition to applying for the O'Leary Ventures internship. You never want to have all your eggs in one basket.
4. **Go with the flow.** Part of being an intern is learning how to adapt, even if it means doing tasks that weren't part of the original job description. The O'Leary interns are particularly good at this. Ramin says, "On my very first day at the office, I was given the names of 10 companies that I had never heard of and was asked to 'start the due diligence process.' I wasn't sure what any of these companies did or what the 'due